

PARANORMAL NOBODIES

Episode 101

"VODKA AND OTHER SPIRITS"

Written by

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Based on

"The Haunting of Dylan Klaypool: Whispers in Black Willow"
by James A. Ross

Production White_12/28/22

ACT 1

1

EXT. SALEM 1692, MEETINGHOUSE OF THE FIRST CHURCH - DAY

1

A monochromatic landscape of powder blue, obscured by the violent winter WINDS of a bitter and dense BLIZZARD.

The PSALM of an a capella choir reverberates throughout the barren, young town and into the snow-covered woods beyond.

CHOIR (O.S.)

(Singing)

*The Lord is compassionate and
gracious / Slow to anger, abounding
in love.*

Clothed in burnt orange comes **SARAH GOOD (pregnant)** and her daughter, **DOROTHY (4)**. Dorothy clings to her mother's skirt, skipping to keep up, to stay warm.

SUPER: Salem, 1692.

CHOIR (CONT'D)

(Singing)

*He will not always accuse,
nor will he harbor His anger
forever / He does not treat
us as our sins deserve or
repay us according to our
iniquities / For as high as
the Heavens are above the
earth, so great is his love
for those who fear Him / As
far as the east is from the
west, so far has He removed
our transgressions from us.*

DOROTHY

(Singing)

*He will not always accuse,
nor will he harbor His anger
forever / He does not treat
us as our sins deserve or
repay us according to our
iniquities / For as high as
the Heavens are above the
earth, so great is his love
for those who fear Him-*

Sarah turns to face the church, on edge.

SARAH

You must prepare, dear Dorothy.
Dorothy! They come. They come.

PURITANS clothed in black and gray pour from the church.
Dorothy dives into the swarm, holding her apron out.

DOROTHY

Please. A shilling or two. Please,
Sir. Ma'am?

(CONTINUED)

MEN and **WOMEN** scorn the child in silence, continue walking. One **WOMAN** tosses Dorothy a SHILLING, addresses her **HUSBAND** as they move without ceasing.

WOMAN

I pity the child. That Sarah has
yet to teach her how young adults
should not speak lest spoken to.

Overhearing, Dorothy frowns. **ABIGAIL WILLIAMS (11)** and **BETTY PARRIS (9)** approach her from behind, take the coin. Giggle.

DOROTHY

Give it back, please. Abigail,
please!

ABIGAIL

It does not belong to you, Dorcas.
Begging is not an occupation. Am I
not correct, Betty?

BETTY

You are entirely correct, Cousin.

DOROTHY

She is not! She lies!

ABIGAIL

I do not!

DOROTHY

You liar!

ABIGAIL

You burden!

TITUBA (O.S.)

Girls.

Dorothy turns, follows the blue garb up until she meets the eyes of **TITUBA (18)**, a Native South American slave.

BETTY

She's mad, Tituba! Like the sinners
in your stories. Make her stop, I
beg of you.

DOROTHY

I am not mad!

BETTY

You can see it. Can you not? Oh, I
am afraid of her.

(CONTINUED)

ABIGAIL

Yes! Terribly afraid. Make her go,
Tituba. Please do!

BETTY

Please!

ABIGAIL (CONT'D)

Please!

TITUBA

Thou shalt not steal, Abigail.

Abigail fumes, returns the shilling to Dorothy.

TITUBA (CONT'D)

Now, forth unto the house of
Parris.

The girls run off. Tituba is following them at a leisure pace
when a COMPASS falls from her person and onto the snow.

Dorothy notices the error, rushes towards the compass.

DOROTHY

Tituba! Tituba!

Tituba turns. She looks down to see Dorothy holding up her
compass.

DOROTHY (CONT'D)

This fell from you, I saw. Here you
are.

Tituba takes the compass.

DOROTHY (CONT'D)

What is it?

TITUBA

A compass, Child. To tell North.
North from South, East from West.

DOROTHY

(awestruck)

May I see?

TITUBA

Yes, if it were not broken and thus
useless. Keep it, Child, but know
it points in a wrong direction.

DOROTHY

I could not.

TITUBA

Go on. No fortune is to be made.

(CONTINUED)

1 CONTINUED: (3)

DOROTHY

Thank you. Thank you, dearly.

Dorothy HUGS a stunned Tituba. She lets go, looks at the starved child like she's a mirror reflection of her past.

TITUBA

I shall approach my Master Parris
the Minister about a room for your
family, yes?

DOROTHY

Oh! Tituba...

TITUBA

We shall see.

Tituba smiles and Dorothy watches her walk away.

Dorothy gazes at her new compass, follows the eye line pointing north: the white woods.

She spots an ORANGE SNAKE and, before her very own eyes, the creature MORPHS into **SAMUEL RAY (40s)**. He turns and LOOKS directly at her, directly at us.

2 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE CHICAGO / DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 2

DYLAN KLAYPOOL (16) awakens in a cold sweat, gasping for air. She has a permanent, subtle SCAR around her eye.

By the blue light of her TV screen, Dylan is attempting a return to real life when she hears an old cartoon of Casper the Friendly Ghost. She shuts it off in a hurry.

*
*
*

SUPER: Chicago, 2017.

Dylan checks the time: 3AM, as expected. She considers, turns her morning alarm off, and rolls out of bed in a Taylor Swift t-shirt. Speak Now. Both of her arms are covered with scars.

MUSIC plays that is both comforting and unsettling, almost imbalanced.

Dylan pours hot COFFEE into a TEACUP, takes it black.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE CHICAGO - NIGHT

*

Dylan sits on the front steps of her house, watching while occasionally sipping coffee. Some **TEENAGERS** cross her street, drunk and happy. She watches them pass her by.

*
*
*

4 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE CHICAGO / KITCHEN - NIGHT** 4 *

Dylan fries two sunny-side-up EGGS in a PAN, pours them onto a childlike PLATE with a side of TOAST and AVOCADO.

At the BREAKFAST TABLE, Dylan eats alone while reading Little Women by Louisa May Alcott. Avocado falls from her toast. *

The phone BUZZES with a reminder: "Visit day!!" Dylan smiles.

7 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE CHICAGO / DYLAN'S ROOM - NIGHT** 7 *

She brushes her teeth in the BATHROOM mirror, covers her face scar with concealer and does the rest of her makeup.

Dylan meticulously forms an outfit. She wraps an open wound on her arm and puts on long sleeves. *

8 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE CHICAGO / KITCHEN - NIGHT** 8

On a sticky note, Dylan writes "Going out. Will be back in the afternoon." She tapes it to the fridge.

A9 **INT. CHICAGO PUBLIC TRANSIT - EARLY MORNING** A9

The early morning colors of AUTUMN blend together behind the window of a moving TRANSIT. Dylan sits, excited. She writes in her JOURNAL while listening to MUSIC: the same song played throughout the opening. It ends. *

An INDIE ROCK SONG with ghastly lyrics BLARES into her ears and a jolted Dylan looks at the phone, disgusted. It's a song called "She's So Mean" by the band STUPID BALL PIT CULT. *

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT *

FOR INSERT INTO
VIDEO PLAYBACK *

A VISUALIZER plays. It's of a boy we'll come to know as MITCH VERLICE (17). He has a PINK buzz cut and a few small TATTOOS. *

He wears a goth graphic TEE and heart-shaped SUNGLASSES, does an ironic dance in the WOODS with a JOINT between his lips, LAUGHING. *

INT. CHICAGO PUBLIC TRANSIT - EARLY MORNING *

Dylan lets the video loop a few times, then changes her *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

settings so that the app will never recommend his band's channel again. She breathes, grabbing her NECKLACE.

BEGIN TITLE SEQUENCE:

"PARANORMAL NOBODIES"

EXT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE - DAY

Dylan looks up at a large, run down building. Walking towards it, she passes a SIGN that says: "CHICAGO STATE HOSPITAL FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE."

SOPHIE (V.O.)

The queen only has power because I
have given it to her.

INT. PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE - DAY

Light sneaks through the windows of a psychiatric hospital for the criminally insane, illuminating an array of **PATIENTS**. **SOPHIE (30s, skin PEELING like a snake's)**, plays CARDS alone.

SOPHIE

What do you give power to? Things
which haunt you day and night and
in between? Ah, it can have all or
it can have none. Do you see?

Dylan observes from her seat. Sophie turns, stares back.

SOPHIE (CONT'D)

SEE!

NATHAN (O.S.)

You remember Sophie, Dylan?

Dylan whips her head around, sees NATHAN KLAYPOOL (40s).

DYLAN

Dad!

She JUMPS into his arms. A NURSE (30s, male) INTERJECTS.

NURSE

Distance.

DYLAN

Sorry.

Dylan and Nathan look at each other, try not to laugh. SIT.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

DYLAN (CONT'D) *
 Dad... I have to tell you- *
 SOPHIE *
 SEE! *
 Dylan turns, sees Sophie peeling her skin. *
 DYLAN *
 (whispering) *
 What happened to Sophie? *
 Nathan's eyes flash to the distracted nurse monitoring him. *
 He reaches for Dylan's ear, pulls out a card: FIVE OF *
 DIAMONDS. With a wave of his hand, is DISAPPEARS. He WINKS. *
 DYLAN (CONT'D) *
 You need to get out of here. *
 A beat: *he might never.* *
 DYLAN (CONT'D) *
 Ten years is more than enough time *
 for someone who's innocent. *
 Nathan smiles, deals BLACKJACK. *
 NATHAN *
 How are things at home, huh? *
 Dylan sees the cards she's been dealt: TWO EIGHTS. She SIGHS. *
 DYLAN *
 Dad. It's Cuppa. *
 Nathan stops playing. *
 DYLAN (CONT'D) *
 She's gone. *
 NATHAN *
 What? No! *
 Nathan's eyes fill with tears. *
 DYLAN *
 She just disappeared. *
 NATHAN *
 What? Do they think she's alive? I *
 mean, what are they saying? *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

DYLAN

You mean what is *Miguel* saying? He
took the case.

Nathan extends his arms, referring to his surroundings.

NATHAN

Miguel? Well, *that* means nothing.

Someone SCREAMS. Dylan startles, but Nathan doesn't flinch.

NATHAN (CONT'D)

And your mom? How is she? Her and
Candice did have their differences,
but that's her mother after all.

DYLAN

Jill is all right.

Snails pace, Nathan resumes the game.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

Um...

The forward facing card Nathan deals is a SIX.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

(re: card game)

Pass.

Nathan peaks under the cards, pulls another one.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

We're leaving Chicago and moving to
Cuppa's house in mom's hometown.

Nathan flips the cards: SEVENTEEN. He leans back, collects
himself. Dylan watches, concerned, cards down.

NATHAN

You should have hit. Always hit.

DYLAN

Aren't you mad?

NATHAN

I'm not mad at all. Completely
sane. But my time for anger is
over.

DYLAN

Well, mine isn't.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (3)

NATHAN *
Maybe it'll be great. And we can *
video call now. I've seen it. *

DYLAN *
Fine, but you're not getting it. *
They're called ghost towns for a *
reason. *

NATHAN *
Black Willow is *not* a ghost town. *

DYLAN *
(almost angry) *
You know what I mean. *

NATHAN *
(re: Dylan's necklace) *
Is it still working? *

DYLAN *
Of course it's still working. Does *
it stop? Dad? *

Dylan SQUIRMS in her seat. *

NATHAN *
No! Of course not, but- *

Nathan hears a HIGH PITCHED SOUND that affects no one else. *

NATHAN (CONT'D) *
He's here. *

DYLAN *
What? *

Nathan STANDS, KNOCKING his chair over. *

NATHAN *
HEY! *

Dylan searches the room as the crowd watches Nathan. *

NATHAN (CONT'D) *
You have to go. Now! *

He's RESTRAINED by nurses. SCREAMS, tries to FIGHT them off. *

DYLAN *
Stop it! Stop it! *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (4)

NATHAN

Dylan! Believe in the necklace! OK?
It only protects you if...

The nurses INJECT Nathan with medication.

DYLAN

Wait! If what?! Dad!

Nathan's world goes woozy as Dylan watches, breath held.

INT. JILL'S CAR - DAY

Dylan stares at the CAR WINDOW in SILENCE. They pass a road sign that says: "ENTERING BLACK WILLOW, MA EST. 1693."

JILL RODRIGUEZ (40s) sits in the passenger's seat reading a MAGAZINE about women in neuroscience. She is on the cover.

MIGUEL RODRIGUEZ (50s), DRIVES. He looks at Dylan from the rear view mirror.

MIGUEL

Are you excited about your new school, Dylan? Could be pretty cool, huh? You can rebrand. Buy a cat, cut your hair real short, maybe even introduce yourself as Dill and nobody would know the difference. Am I right?

Miguel LAUGHS, but Dylan never acknowledges him.

JILL

Dylan. Your step father is speaking to you.

MIGUEL

It's fine. The headphones.

She looks at her phone. The song is PAUSED. They drive on. Dylan PLAYS the song and looks at her new TOWN, where all you can do is dance in parking lots or get high at house parties.

13

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - DUSK

13

Miguel pulls into their new HOUSE, which is very old. Dylan looks across the open FIELD, at a BOY (Mitch) digging GRAVES.

(CONTINUED)

13 CONTINUED:

DYLAN

Really, Mom? You don't think you should have mentioned that Cuppa's house is literally like two acres away from a graveyard?

JILL

I don't see why that would be a problem. Do you, Honey?

*

Miguel sees them stare each other down.

MIGUEL

Uh... You know what? Dylan, we've got this. Why don't you explore the house? I could use an inspector.

Miguel hands Dylan a NOTEPAD and PEN.

MIGUEL (CONT'D)

Take note of everything that needs fixing. Yeah?

DYLAN

Sure.

Miguel smiles. Jill rolls her eyes.

14 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT**

14

Dylan enters the house. It's still filled with Candice's BELONGINGS. She tries to swallow the discomfort.

She takes a step, the floors CREEK like crazy. She repeats, the floor creaks even LOUDER. She writes it down.

15 **INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / KITCHEN - NIGHT**

15

Dylan enters the kitchen and opens the FRIDGE. She gags at the discovery of ROTTEN FOOD.

Dylan tries the STOVE. It works. A drop of water falls on her head. She looks up, sees a LEAK and rolls her eyes.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / STAIRCASE - NIGHT

*

Dylan hops up the staircase.

*

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / BATHROOM - NIGHT

*

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

Dylan opens the bathroom, a COCKROACH runs out. She SCREAMS, sees ANOTHER on the floor that is struggling to get back up.

Dylan grabs a CUP from the sink, covers the bug and slides PAPER underneath it. The cockroach WAKES UP running. She holds it at arms length, grossed out.

18

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

18

Dylan walks to a room, opens a WINDOW. She let's the bug go and looks around the bedroom. It'll be her's. She notices a puddle at her feet: that leak. It leads to the FIREPLACE. After inspection, Dylan discovers that it's a SECRET DOOR.

With caution, she peaks her head inside to find a narrow, brick hallway that's been PAINTED with abstract images.

19

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / SECRET CORRIDOR - NIGHT

19

Dylan enters the corridor. She follows a trail of TWINKLE LIGHTS until it brings her to stairs that reach the ceiling.

20

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / ATTIC - NIGHT

20

Dylan peeks her head into the attic: like an antique shop with MURALS. She bags an old PHOTO of her, Jill, and Nathan.

Dylan HEARS the leak drip on metal, follows the sound to find a soaked KEY on a 17TH CENTURY DESK. It opens like a flower.

Inside is GHOST HUNTING EQUIPMENT. Eyes wide, she closes the desk and looks out of the attic WINDOW.

Dylan sees it in the early nighttime fog: an ABANDONED HOUSE.

END OF ACT 1

(CONTINUED)

ACT 2

21 EXT. SCHOOL BUS - DAY 21

Dylan watches the SCHOOL BUS doors open, hears THUNDER crack *
in the heavens. She wears a UNIFORM. *

DYLAN

Hi. *

Dylan ascends the steps, disgusted, and sits alone in the back. After sanitizing her hands, she reads.

22 INT. MS.MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - DAY 22

Uniformed **STUDENTS** talk. Some sit atop their desks, others
draw on the board. It says: "#MeToo." Dylan sits, head down,
writing in her JOURNAL as it RAINS.

The english teacher, **TAMARA MARRERO (32, gorgeous)**, walks into her class, **LAUGHS** as everyone scrambles to their desks. *

TAMARA

All right. All right.

A **BOY** in the back HOLLERS and some students LAUGH.

TAMARA (CONT'D)

Boys!

BOY #1

Sorry, Ms.Marrero!

BOY #2

We love you.

She LAUGHS.

TAMARA

Ok right. That's enough. Yeah?
Don't wanna give our new student
the wrong impression. Welcome to
Honors English, Dylan.

Taken off guard, Dylan smiles and puts her head back down. *

TAMARA (CONT'D)

Okay then.

(CONTINUED)

CARRIE (16, effortlessly feminine with a rebellious eye)
leans over her desk, WHISPERS to **LEXIE (16)**.

TAMARA (CONT'D)
We're starting a fun play
today, actually. Should be
perfect for October. Has
anyone here ever read The
Crucible?

CARRIE
She hated that. Look. I can
always tell when someone's an
attention whore.

TAMARA (CONT'D)
Carrie?

Carrie bats her eyes.

CARRIE
Yes, Ms.Marrero?

TAMARA
Is there something you would like
to share with the rest of us?

CARRIE
No, Ma'am.

TAMARA
Then keep quiet and pay attention.
This goes for all of you. I will
not tolerate my class being
interrupted. Now, as I was saying-

MITCH (O.S.)
Am I late?

In the doorway, but now with blue hair, stands Mitch Verlice.
He's DRENCHED from the rain. Tamara does her best to restrict
a smirk as he smiles.

TAMARA
No, Mitchell. You're quite alive.

Mitch LAUGHS: a short, loud laugh.

MITCH
That's good, Tamara Marrero. That's
really good.

Students roll their eyes and exchange side glances.

TAMARA
You haven't missed much. Take a
seat.

(CONTINUED)

MITCH
Without further ado.

Mitch plops onto the desk in front of Dylan's, SOAKING her journal. *

DYLAN
WHAT THE HELL, DIPSTICK?!

Mitch turns around, a grin plastered to his face.

MITCH
Dipstick?

An angry, embarrassed Dylan stares at him. He looks familiar. *

MITCH (CONT'D)
My name is actually Mitch.

DYLAN
Am I supposed to care?

Mitch looks at Dylan, bemused. He SNATCHES her journal, chews GUM as he reads it. Carrie raises her hand.

CARRIE
Excuse me?

TAMARA
Yes, Carrie?

CARRIE
Yeah. I was just wondering. Mitch didn't get in trouble for being late in the same way the rest of us would because? Just seems a little wrong. Don't cha think, Tamara?

TAMARA
Carrie-

CARRIE
I mean, what was the hold up anyway Mitch? Why are you all wet in Ms.Marrero's class?

Without looking away from Dylan's journal, Mitch holds up his pointer finger, signaling Carrie to wait. He takes the page in a second more, hands it back to Dylan with no reaction.

Dylan sees the page: a POEM. She refocuses on class, ashamed and annoyed. Mitch turns to Carrie with a smile. *

(CONTINUED)

MITCH

My whereabouts are none of your
concern. Are they, Carrie?

CARRIE

No. I'm not concerned about you at
all.

They stare each other down until Carrie breaks eye contact.
Sitting behind Carrie is **VEDA (16, goth)**. Veda SEES a sadness
in Mitch and grabs SCISSORS, she cuts a strand of Carrie's
hair. Carrie grabs her head and SCREAMS.

*
*
*INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - DAY

Dylan shuts her LOCKER and walks through school. A dean, **JOHN
RICHARD (50s)** walks down the halls like an officer.

*

JOHN

You. Straight brown hair. Yes, you.
That skirt looks a little short,
no? Hands by your side... cutting
it close, but you're free to go.

*

He keeps walking, points at multiple **STUDENTS**.

JOHN (CONT'D)

Tuck in the shirt. Shirt! Shirt!

Dylan is invisible to him, to everyone except Mitch: who she
sees STARING AT HER from a distance.

*
*

Mitch watches Dylan walk away, his intense gaze turning into
a curious smile as Veda sorts through her locker.

*

VEDA

Stupid Ball Pit Cult needs a new
member.

Veda sees Mitch watching Dylan, passes him a FLYER about an
audition for Stupid Ball Pit Cult: that band Dylan blocked.

*
*

MITCH

You don't think it's too soon to be
replacing Chayton?

VEDA

He wanted to leave. He left. And
the moment he did, he died to me.

MITCH

Veda...

*
*

(CONTINUED)

VEDA

That's all.

*

MITCH

Come on, V. We always knew he
wanted to live at the reservation
with the rest of your family. Have
you heard from him? How's he doing?

*

*

*

*

*

VEDA

You mean in hell where he is
because, as I said, he's dead to
me? How should I know? I'm not
there yet.

Veda takes a pile of flyers from her locker, SLAMS it. She
snatches the one she gave Mitch and walks away.

*

INT. CAFETERIA - DAY

Dylan stands in the lunch line. A lunch lady, **MRS.SANTOS**,
plops a pile of MYSTERY MEAT onto Dylan's plate.

DYLAN

Thank you. Do you have, uh...

*

Mitch slides into the line, smirking at an annoyed Dylan.

MITCH

(in Spanish, subtitled)
Señora Santos! How are you,
beautiful? And what's this?

MRS.SANTOS

(in Spanish, subtitled)
Who knows? Don't tell the girl, but
there could be horse shit in here
and she wouldn't know it.

Mitch GASPS.

MITCH

(to Dylan)
She says this stuff's impeccable.
Top of the line, grade A. You've
gotta try it.

DYLAN

(in Spanish, subtitled)
I'll pass, but thank you very much.

*

*

*

Mrs.Santos LAUGHS and Mitch grins, defeated. Dylan grabs a
SANDWICH and hesitates in her search for a table.

*

*

(CONTINUED)

MITCH

(faux sympathy)

Do you wanna sit with me at lunch,
Dipstick?

DYLAN

It's Dylan.

MITCH

Am I supposed to care?

Dylan walks away. Mitch lifts his hands in surrender.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Offer still stands.

DYLAN

I'll pass, but thank you very much.

Mitch watches her struggle and look back at him, embarrassed.
She leaves the cafeteria in a pout. Mitch turns to Mrs.Santos
and gives her a look.

25

INT. SCHOOL / HALLWAY - DAY

25

Dylan leaves the cafeteria with her FOOD. Head down, she
walks past STUDENTS eating in groups on the hallway floor.

26

EXT. SCHOOL - DAY

26

Dylan opens double doors and finds herself on the steps of
her school's entrance. RAIN pours. She sees the LIBRARY and
puts her hand out to check the rain's intensity. Runs for it.

27

INT. SCHOOL / LIBRARY - DAY

27

Dylan enters the library, shaking out her wet hair. She looks
around in awe only to land on the eyes of an angry LIBRARIAN,
who points to a "no food" SIGN.

EXT. SCHOOL / PLAYGROUND - DAY

Dylan walks past the playground, starting to surrender.

EXT. SCHOOL / FOOTBALL FIELD - DAY

Dylan slushes across the empty FOOTBALL FIELD on glistening

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

BLEACHERS. She SLIPS and FALLS flat on her ass. *

DYLAN
FUCK ME FUCKING FUCK SHIT BITCH!!!!

Dylan lays on the bleachers, squints at a gray sky. *

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Why do you hate me?

She looks over and catches the stare of **SAWYER HALL (17)**, who has been watching her from under the bleachers. Eyes wide and mortified, Dylan pulls herself together and walks away. *

SAWYER
(calling out)
I don't think I'd hate you if that helps.

Dylan doesn't look back.

DYLAN
OK. It doesn't really, but thank you. Bye now.

SAWYER
Wait.

Dylan turns and Sawyer tosses her his only UMBRELLA.

DYLAN
(genuine)
Thanks.

Dylan walks away as Sawyer smirks between rosy cheeks.

INT. SCHOOL / HALLWAY - DAY *

Dylan opens the school doors, soaked. Closing the umbrella is an ordeal. As she walks by, students move their food. *

PARKER HALL (17, Sawyer's fraternal twin), comes out of the cafeteria with his **TEAMMATES**. *

PARKER
Go long! *

His PAPER BALL hits Dylan on the head. She looks at him, mad. *

PARKER (CONT'D)
Shit! Sorry. Didn't see you there. *

He turns towards his friends: *yikes*. *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

Dylan opens the paper ball. It's an audition flyer for Stupid Ball Pit Cult. She stares at the PHOTO of Mitch on the front and marches into the girl's restroom, fuming. *

31

INT. SCHOOL / GIRL'S RESTROOM - DAY

31

Dylan sees her horrid appearance in the girl's restroom mirror and rushes into a STALL. She pours water out of her shoe, throws it against the door. *Breathe.* *

The FLYER. She pulls it out, looks up the band's social media. After some light stalking, she finds Mitch's account. *Yeah. It's the same person.* She puts the phone away and takes out her SANDWICH. Her tears soak the stale bread. *

DAYS PASS in that stall. Different lunches. Different books. Different positions. Different hair styles. *

Carrie and Lexie enter, VAPING. *

LEXIE
Literally. Like it's so annoying. *

CARRIE
I need a bobby pin. Thanks, Baby. *

LEXIE
Hey so how's Parker? *

CARRIE
Magical. Grabs my ass. *

LEXIE
Spicy. *

CARRIE
I know. But no, seriously. It's cool. OK I wanna tell you a secret, but you have to swear you won't tell a single soul. Swear it. *

LEXIE
I swear it. *

CARRIE
Pinkie promise. Kiss it. OK now suck it. *

Lexie fakes out going to suck Carrie's finger. Carrie grins. *

CARRIE (CONT'D)
I low key literally has a boyfriend this Summer. Like serious as hell. *

(CONTINUED)

LEXIE *
Carrie! Look at you! *

CARRIE *
No, listen. We broke up because I'm *
like 99.9% sure he was cheating on *
me with, write this shit down, a *
whole ass teacher, Lexie. *

LEXIE *
Shut the hell up! Ew! *

CARRIE *
Yeah. Yeah. No, I know. It's *
literally disgusting. *

LEXIE *
Who is he? *

CARRIE *
Lexie, it's so embarrassing. *

LEXIE *
I won't tell. I swear. *

CARRIE *
Mitch Verlice. *

In the stall, Dylan REACTS: *of course* it's Mitch Verlice. *

LEXIE *
Shut up! *

CARRIE *
Bitch, chill! *

Lexie lowers her voice. *

LEXIE *
Isn't he like a gravedigger? *

CARRIE *
I mean yeah, but like he also has *
tattoos so... *

LEXIE *
Wait is that why you guys are *
always so weird in class?! *

Carrie gives her a look. *

LEXIE (CONT'D) *
Shit! Is the teacher Ms.Marrero?! *

(CONTINUED)

CARRIE

Like that's a surprise.

LEXIE

Ew! Get her fired. What the hell?
That's literally illegal.

CARRIE

I already tried, Dude. I slipped a
note under the principal's door
like a freaking nark or something.

LEXIE

And?

CARRIE

And nothing happened. Obviously.

LEXIE

What? But why-

Dylan DROPS her food. The girls go quiet, look at the stall.
Dylan FLUSHES, steps out while trying to avoid eye contact.
As she washes her hands, Carrie and Lexie exchange a glance.

CARRIE

I love your shoes.

Dylan looks down: a pair of platformed LOAFERS.

DYLAN

Oh. Thank you.

CARRIE

Are they vintage?

DYLAN

No. I don't really like vintage
things. They kinda creep me out.
Like, who owned this before and
what kind of energy did they leave
it with? You know...

CARRIE

That's too bad. I think vintage is
badass.

DYLAN

Oh. Aren't you ever worried someone
passed away in your clothes?

Carrie and Lexie stare at her.

(CONTINUED)

CARRIE

Dylan. It's Dylan, right? Please
don't tell me you were eating lunch
all alone in that disgusting stall.

DYLAN

It's not really a big deal.

CARRIE

People shit in there, Dylan. OK.
Come one. Take my hand. Let's go.

DYLAN

Where are we going?

CARRIE

To our table. Duh!

Dylan takes Carrie's hand.

INT. CAFETERIA - DAY

Dylan sits with Carrie, Lexie, **DAKOTA (16)**, and **MIA (16)**.

LEXIE

What are you guys wearing for the
Halloween dance?

DAKOTA

Oh, are we actually going to that?

MIA

I want to. Aw, we can do like a
group costume. That would literally
be so adorable.

Dylan looks across the cafeteria and sees Mitch STARING her
down again, amused. Annoyed, she looks away.

LEXIE

Aw yes!

CARRIE

Mia, I love you, but there's no way
in hell I'm doing that.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

LEXIE MIA
Yeah. Maybe- Kiss my ass, Carrie. *

CARRIE *
I can eat it too if you'd like.

Mia and Carrie LAUGH.

LEXIE
Yeah. Maybe we shouldn't do a group
costume. It's a little, like, lame.

A beat.

DAKOTA
Do you think I'd get in trouble for
going as a blunt? But, like, in a
hot way.

MIA
What would that even look like?

Dylan receives an AIRDROP from Mitch's iPhone. It's a MEME
that says: "disappointed but not surprised." *

DAKOTA
I'm thinking like a mummy with a
green wig maybe.

Dylan looks at Mitch, who's smiling. She FLIPS HIM OFF. *

CARRIE *
That's hot. *

DAKOTA *
Hey, new girl. Hello? *

MIA *
Gosh, Dakota. She has a name. It's
Dylan! *

Dylan jumps a little, refocuses on the group. *

DAKOTA *
OK, Mom. Are you going to the
Halloween dance, Dylan. *

DYLAN *
Um, I don't really celebrate
Halloween. *

MIA DAKOTA
No! Is that like a religious
thing? *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

DYLAN

No, it's not. I just-

Parker comes up from behind Carrie and sneak attacks her.

CARRIE

Chill! You scared me. Baby, this is
Dylan. Dylan, this is Parker and
his brother. Um...

SAWYER

Sawyer.

DYLAN

We met.

Dylan gives Sawyer a slight smile and he nods, blushing.

SAWYER

You're not, uh, wet anymore.

PARKER

Wet? What? Did you guys like fuck
or something?

SAWYER

Parker!

MIA

Holy shit!

Uncomfortable, Dylan forces a laugh.

DYLAN

Uh. No. I'm only sixteen so yeah
that'd be kinda crazy.

Carrie looks a little stung.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

I mean...everyone is different, but
I haven't done that yet so.

PARKER

Weird flex, but OK.

SAWYER

Dude, can you just like chill?

Carrie whispers in Parker's ear.

CARRIE

Be nice. I'll give you community
service hours later.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (3)

PARKER

Dylan. It's Dylan, yeah? You're so right. I'm really sorry. Uh, where are you from?

DYLAN

Chicago. Windy, Oprah...

Dylan laughs to herself.

PARKER

What?

DYLAN

Nothing. It's just, that was from this show I like.

PARKER

Oh.

Awkward silence. Carrie and Lexie exchange a glance. Dylan receives another AIRDROP from Mitch: a dark humored IMAGE of Ken the doll that *almost* makes her laugh.

CARRIE

Where'd you move to in town?

DYLAN

Um. Willow Road.

CARRIE

Wait. Seriously?

MIA

Isn't that where the house is?

DYLAN

What house?

CARRIE

I keep forgetting how new you are. The haunted house. It's literally a classic. We go all the time.

DYLAN

Is it actually haunted?

DAKOTA

Hell yeah. Since the 80s. No one really knows why.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (4)

CARRIE

I heard a bunch of religious freaks
with guns busted up an orgy fest in
there.

Mitch watches Dylan's demeanor build in discomfort. He sends
her an AIRDROP of two eyeballs touching that says, "are you
uncomfortable with eye contact?" She doesn't react.

MIA

No way! It was a girl who got
kidnapped in an ice cream truck,
remember? The guy locked her in
that room upstairs and one day she
killed his ass.

PARKER

You're all so full of shit. It's
just a good spot to hook up.

He digs his fingers into Carrie's side.

LEXIE

I mean, you're not wrong.

DAKOTA

Yeah he is. You're telling me that
you guys have never felt anything
weird in that house? Unexplained
voices. Cold winds. Something
definitely went down in there.

MIA

I bet graveyard boy knows. I think
he's your neighbor, Dylan.

They look at Mitch. He doesn't flinch, locked in on Dylan.

DYLAN

Of course he is.

Mitch's devil-may-care expression, though borderline cheery,
seems to say: are you OK? And Carrie NOTICES.

CARRIE

Let's go tonight.

DYLAN

Uh. I really can't.

CARRIE

Uh. I think you can. Come one.
Girls only. It's like an
initiation.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (5)

DYLAN

No, you don't understand-

*

CARRIE

You're coming. Kay? Text me your
address. It'll be so much fun.

Dylan gets another airdrop from Mitch. This time, it's his
SONG: "She's so Mean" by STUPID BALL PIT CULT. Dylan gives
him a defiant look and then turns back to Carrie, SMILING.

*

*

*

DYLAN

Kay.

END OF ACT 2

ACT 3

39

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

39

Dylan scours through a pile of clothing as Jill walks by. *

DYLAN *

Mom! Do you still have that
oversized leather jacket? *

JILL *

From the thrift store? Yeah, but I
thought you didn't like it because- *

DYLAN

Mom! The jacket. Please. Carrie,
Lexie, Dakota, and Mia are gonna be
here any second and- *

The doorbell RINGS. *

DYLAN (CONT'D) *

Oh my gosh. Oh my gosh. *

JILL

Calm down. The jacket is in my
closet. You go get it while I go
get the door.

Jill heads downstairs, a skip in her step.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT *

Jill opens the front door. Carrie, Dakota, Lexie, and Mia
stand there looking innocent as ever. *

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / JILL'S CLOSET - NIGHT *

Dylan hesitates before putting on the jacket. *

JILL (O.S.) *

Dylan. You're friends are here. *

Dylan clutches her necklace. *

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / LIVING ROOM *

Dylan descends the stairs. *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

MIA

I love your jacket, Dylan.

DYLAN

Thanks! It's vintage.

Carrie catches that comment as Jill whispers in Dylan's ear.

JILL

Home by lam, you hear me?

Dylan nods and Carrie takes her by the arm.

CARRIE

Not to worry, Dylan's mom! We'll
take good care of her. I promise.

Carrie waves goodbye and Jill closes the door, excited.

43

INT. POLICE DEPARTMENT - NIGHT

43 *

A PLAQUE on the desk reads: "RONALD HODGE, POLICE CHIEF."
RONALD HODGE (60s, plastic surgery) turns around in his desk.

HODGE

Detective Miguel Rodriguez. Welcome
to Black Willow. We've been looking
for Candice, quite a while now.

MIGUEL (O.S.)

Any leads? I mean...

Miguel is REVEALED, sitting across from Hodge.

MIGUEL (CONT'D)

This one's personal.

HODGE

Understood.

Hodge pulls PHOTOS from a FILE, puts them in front of Miguel.

HODGE (CONT'D)

This is all we got. Her car was
found, side of the road in
Edgartown. Not far from Lighthouse
Beach. No blood. No nothing. Just
an open door.

MIGUEL

Any way I can see the possessions
in her vehicle?

(CONTINUED)

HODGE

Sure thing. Might take a few days,
but we'll get it to you.

MORGAN HALL (40s, in a pantsuit) KNOCKS on Hodge's WINDOW and waves, a PHONE to her ear. She walks around, enters.

MORGAN (O.S.)

Well, they can kiss my ass,
Jennifer.

Morgan signals for the men to wait.

MORGAN (CONT'D)

Yeah no. Tell Fox I appreciate the
gesture, but also that I hate them.
All right. I gotta go.

She hangs up, shines a bright smile.

MORGAN (CONT'D)

Jeez, it smells like shit in here,
Ronald. What is that? Decay?

HODGE

Detective Rodriguez, Mayor Hall.

A shocked Miguel STANDS. He shakes Morgan's hand.

MIGUEL

An honor to meet you, Mayor Hall.

MORGAN

Hi. I love it. Yeah. Listen Ronald,
my boys have this Civics thing.
They've gotta talk to someone who
works for the city and I'm swamped.
You think you can handle it? I want
someone good, you know? For fuck's
sake, their mother is the mayor.

HODGE

Sure thing.

MORGAN

You're a life saver, you know that?
Boys!

Sawyer and Parker peek their heads into the window.

MORGAN (CONT'D)

(to Miguel)

He's a life saver.

(CONTINUED)

The boys enter. Parker is on his phone. *

MORGAN (CONT'D)

Be good!

Morgan points at them and LEAVES. *

SAWYER *

I'm really sorry about this. *

HODGE *

No problem whatsoever. *

Sawyer nudges Parker. *

PARKER *

Dude! What? Oh. Thanks? *

Hodge forces a smile in the awkward silence. *

MIGUEL *

Well, I think I'm gonna head out. *

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT *

Carrie, Lexie, Mia, and Dakota walk with Dylan. Carrie wears heart-shaped SUNGLASSES, smokes a VAPE and blows into the face of whoever she's talking to. *

CARRIE *

(to Dylan) *

I hope you can hang. *

Carrie takes a sip from her water BOTTLE. *

CARRIE (CONT'D) *

Anyone thirsty? *

LEXIE

Me, please.

MIA

Hit me. *

DYLAN *

I'll have some. *

Carrie smirks, hands Dylan the bottle. Dylan takes a big gulp and SPITS IT OUT. *

DYLAN (CONT'D) *

What is that?!

CARRIE *

You're so cute! Baby, it's vodka. *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

DYLAN

Oh.

CARRIE

Yeah. Oh. Don't waste it, kay?

DYLAN

It's fine. I don't want any.

Carrie and Dakota lock eyes, annoyed.

EXT. ABANDONED HOUSE - NIGHT

The girls get to the abandoned house GATE. Dylan steps back.

DYLAN

I can't do this. I'm sorry.

CARRIE

Baby. Baby. If this was easy, it
wouldn't be an initiation.

Carrie takes Dylan's hand, pulls her as the others push.

DYLAN

No. Carrie. You don't get it. STOP!

The girls stop. Carrie gives Dakota a look.

CARRIE

I'll tell you what. We're gonna go
inside. Just come when you're
ready, kay?Carrie, Lexie, and Mia climb the gate, go inside. Dakota
stays behind. She pulls out a MINT BOX from her bag.

DAKOTA

No one has ever needed this more.

Dakota hands Dylan a GUMMY.

DYLAN

What is it?

DAKOTA

An edible, obviously.

DYLAN

Is it intense?

DAKOTA

Just trust me. You need it. If it
(MORE)

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

DAKOTA (CONT'D)

makes you feel better, you can-

Dylan tosses the gummy in her mouth without hesitation.

DAKOTA (CONT'D)

Damn, girl. All right.

DYLAN

So. How long does it take to hit?

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - NIGHT

High as hell, Dylan enters the haunted house in awe.

DYLAN

This place is beautiful underneath
all the dust. You ever think of
that? Where dust comes from. And
where it goes. Where does the dust
go? Like, is it ever really gone?

The girls SIT, amused, drinking and smoking in a circle.

CARRIE

Take a seat, Baby. We were just
about to do a seance.

Dylan looks: at the center of them is an OUIJA BOARD.

DYLAN

What the fuck. Why? Why would you
do that?

CARRIE

You've gotta stop worrying so much.
It's actually giving me a migraine.

DAKOTA

It's cool, Dylan. Really. The dead
are like totally chill. We chat
with them all the time.

DYLAN

Uh-uh. Nope. You have no idea what
you're messing with. Seriously.

CARRIE

I heard that anyone in the building
who doesn't play gets bad luck.

DYLAN

Wait, for real? Don't lie to me.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

CARRIE

You don't wanna risk it, do you? *

DYLAN

I'm not a big risk taker.

CARRIE

So play.

Dylan joins the circle, puts her fingers on the moving PIECE.

CARRIE (CONT'D)

Is there a spirit with us?

They watch in anticipation. The piece moves: YES. The girls
GASP, look around. Dylan remains still, intense. *

CARRIE (CONT'D)

Are you good or bad? *

The piece moves: B-A-D. They exchange glances of concern as
Dylan SQUIRMS. *

CARRIE (CONT'D)

What do you want?

The piece moves at a snail's pace: D-Y-L-A-N. She **FAINTS**.

CARRIE (CONT'D)

Fuck!

LEXIE

What happened?

MIA

Dakota, was the weed bad?

DAKOTA

I don't know! I don't fucking know!

Mia tries to wake Dylan up.

MIA

Dylan. Dylan, are you OK?

LEXIE

Is she breathing?!

MIA

Yeah! Yes! I think she fainted.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

DAKOTA

Fuck, what do we do? Guys, what do we do? What if it was my weed? The dealer was kinda sketchy.

LEXIE

Why'd you give it to her then?!

DAKOTA

I'm sorry! OK? I'm sorry!

CARRIE

It's fine! She fainted. She'll come to. Let's just get the hell out of here, OK?

They all stare at her, not moving.

CARRIE (CONT'D)

Come on!

They pick up, RUN away. Carrie leaves her PURSE behind, open. Red LIPSTICK rolls across the floor.

47

INT. KLAYPOOL CHICAGO / DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

47

FLASHBACK

YOUNG DYLAN (8) opens her unscarred eyes. They dart around the room: a little girl's bedroom, quiet as a mouse.

Still glass of WATER on a nightstand. Water ripples with the SOUND of distant footsteps. Another and another and now the water is making waves and something is coming. *

Dylan hides under the COVERS, turns on a FLASHLIGHT. All goes quiet. She peaks her head out and there it is: that faceless, dark figure, **THE SHADOW MAN**. She SCREAMS. *

In the hall, Nathan wakes up amongst a pile of GHOST HUNTING EQUIPMENT. He runs to Dylan, catching a glimpse of the shadow man as he ESCAPES. *

NATHAN

DAMN IT! Dylan!

Dylan CRIES, a CUT on her eye and CUTS all over her arms that look as though the creature was trying to drag her with it.

NATHAN (CONT'D)

You're OK. You're OK. Look at me.
Dylan, he's gone. He's gone.

(MORE)

(CONTINUED)

NATHAN (CONT'D)

We're gonna get your bandages.
We're gonna clean you up. Dylan.

Nathan fails to calm her down. He puts a NECKLACE in her palm *
and she OPENS her eyes.

NATHAN (CONT'D)

Wear this necklace at all times, *
OK? It's magic. It'll protect you *
from that mean ghost who keeps *
coming. OK? But you've gotta *
believe it. You believe it? *

Dylan nods, hesitant. Nathan helps her put on the necklace. *

NATHAN (CONT'D)

You're my daughter, yeah? My
princess. And I'm pretty brave,
aren't I?

Dylan nods.

NATHAN (CONT'D)

That's right. So you're brave too. *
And as long as you believe in this *
necklace here, you're safe. Nothing *
can hurt you. Not that ghost. Not *
anything. OK? Do you believe me? *

Dylan dries her tears, smearing the blood on her wound.

YOUNG DYLAN

OK, Daddy. I believe you.

Jill enters, sees her daughter's cuts. She looks at Nathan, *
horrified.

END OF ACT 3

ACT 4

48

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - DAWN

48

Sunlight through dusty windows of the abandoned house hits Dylan's face. She wakes up, clutches her necklace.

On a mirror, Dylan sees "INNOCENT" written in red lipstick. She catches something GHOSTLY move behind her and sprints to the door, but it's JAMMED shut. She BANGS on it.

DYLAN

Help! Somebody help me! Please!

The door opens and there he is: *Mitch*. He sees tears on her face, fear in her eyes. *The moment feels like minutes*. She RUNS away, towards her house, and he watches her go.

Mitch looks inside and sees the sign.

49

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / KITCHEN - DAY

49

Jill paces the kitchen while Miguel makes the calls.

MIGUEL

Yes. Since this morning. She has long brown hair. Brown eyes-

JILL

Dylan!

Dylan runs in through the front door.

JILL (CONT'D)

Where the hell were-

Dylan HUGS her mom. Jill LOOKS out of the window and sees Mitch where Dylan came from. Protectiveness engulfs her.

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE - DAY

Abiezer (70s) CHOPS wood as Mitch walks towards his house. Abiezer goes to swing and RECOILS his arm in pain. Common.

MITCH

Abi, you OK? Go in. I've got this.

ABIEZER

No. No, Mitcho. No weekends.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

MITCH

It's fine. Go. I made breakfast.

Abiezer goes inside as Mitch goes to swing and-

EXT. GRAVEYARD - NIGHT

His shovel hits dirt again. Mitch wipes his brow, then looks up and sees her: Dylan, bathed in golden light, PRAYING.

Below, Jill pulls into the driveway.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Jill gets groceries from her car, sees smoke in the chimney.

MITCH (O.S.)

Can I help you with that?

Jill SCREAMS, drops a bag. Mitch jumps to pick it up.

MITCH (CONT'D)

I'm so sorry, Mrs. Klaypool. You are Dylan's mom, right?

JILL

Yes. But you can call me Mrs. Rodriquez.

MITCH

Of course. Very sorry. Is Dylan in?

JILL

No, she's not. I believe her and a few friends went out for dinner.

MITCH

Oh, I see. Well, thank you. And sorry again. For the scare.

Mitch leaves, knowing he's unwanted.

52

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / LIVING ROOM - DAY

52 *

Jill goes back inside.

JILL

Dylan, I'm home. You figured out the fireplace?

Dylan peaks her head out from the stair case.

(CONTINUED)

DYLAN

Yeah. What was that scream?

JILL

Oh, nothing. It's stupid. I saw a rat. What are you up to?

DYLAN (O.S.)

Just writing. Nothing much.

Dylan goes back to her room and-

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Sits on her bed, journal open.

JILL (O.S.)

Hey. Do you know where that jacket is? The vintage one.

Dylan looks at her writing: "I was a fool for trying to fit in. No companionship is worth a compromise of character. I burnt the jacket to sanctify my spirit. Mom must never know."

DYLAN

No, I haven't seen it.

Dylan smirks at the burning jacket in her fireplace.

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - DAY

Sawyer stares at the audition FLYER in his hands. He stands with Parker, Carrie, and company. Parker glances at it.

PARKER

Hell no.

SAWYER

Mom said I should do an extracurricular.

PARKER

Yeah. Like hockey. Or debate. Trust me, her and dad don't want you making shit music with a bunch of freaks, Bro.

Dylan ENTERS and the group perks up. She walks away.

CARRIE

Dylan! Dylan, slow down!

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

Dylan TURNS. Mitch WATCHES, more concerned than amused now. *

CARRIE (CONT'D) *
I'm literally so, so sorry about *
Friday. It was supposed to be a *
harmless prank and- *

DYLAN *
What? What was a prank? *

CARRIE *
Like...the Ouija board. We were *
moving it ourselves. *

Dylan pulls out Carrie's PURSE and LIPSTICK. *

CARRIE (CONT'D) *
Oh shit. You found it. *

DYLAN *
Was this a prank too? Or that thing *
in the mirror? *

CARRIE *
What thing in the mirror? *

DYLAN *
Nothing. Um...don't worry about it. *

CARRIE *
We should hang out again. *

DYLAN *
No. I'd rather not. *

CARRIE *
Look. If you don't really wanna be *
friends it's whatever, but...OK. *
Could you just like please keep *
that secret between us? Please? *

A beat. *

DYLAN *
What makes you think I cared enough *
to listen? *

Dylan walks away, but rethinks. *

DYLAN (CONT'D) *
Oh, and Parker? If you ever talk *
about my body again I'll literally *
deck you. *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

Mitch starts LAUGHING uncontrollably.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(to Carrie)
Bad look in a boyfriend, Baby.
Don't cha think?

Dylan walks away as Mitch CLAPS and HOLLERS. Lexie, Mia, and Dakota APPROACH Carrie as he does.

LEXIE
What happened?

MITCH
That's a great question, Lexie.
What *did* happen?

CARRIE
And you're here *because*?

MITCH
What'd you do to Dylan?

CARRIE
We gave her a gummy and the bitch
blacked out. Why do you care?

MITCH
Why do you care that I care?

Parker comes and KISSES Carrie. Mitch laughs, leaves. Carrie TURNS, worried about Mitch's reaction, and Parker NOTICES.

EXT. SCHOOL BUS - DAY

Dylan waits for the school bus. Mitch searches the CROWD until he finds her. He jumps on her BENCH.

MITCH
How was the trip, Mary Jane?

DYLAN
Gosh! You're like a pop-up book
from hell.

MITCH
Rory, season one? Good taste,
Dipstick.

Dylan tries to hide her surprise. The SCHOOL BUS pulls up. She walks towards it and Mitch follows her.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

DYLAN
It's *Dylan*.

MITCH
Dill.

DYLAN
No.

MITCH
Dillstick? Dillstick! Awww. That's
fucking cute.

Mitch PUTS HIMSELF between Dylan and the bus door.

MITCH (CONT'D)
Let me drive you home. Come on!
It's on the way.

DYLAN
Move, please.

MITCH
Think about how good it'll be for
the planet if we made it a regular
thing.

STUDENT
Dude, can you like move?

MITCH
Just a second. Thanks.

BUS DRIVER
Kid! Can you let 'em through? I've
got a schedule to keep here.

Mitch moves out of the way, follows Dylan into the bus.

INT. SCHOOL BUS - DAY

MITCH
Consider the germs on this thing,
Dillstick. Kids picking their nose.
Drool on the windows. Nah. Screw
that. Come with me. Come on. I'll
give you the aux and everything.

DYLAN
One time.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

MITCH

*

HELL YES. That's what I'm *talking*
about.

Mitch forces a random KID to give him a HIGH FIVE.

*

END OF ACT 4

*

ACT 5INT/EXT. MITCH'S BLUE PICKUP TRUCK - DAY

Mitch OPENS his car door for Dylan. There's PARANORMAL KNICK KNACKS everywhere. Dylan PAUSES, sees the bus LEAVE. Mitch smirks at her distress as she enters.

MITCH
Buckle up, Buttercup.

DYLAN
Does that mean we'll go fast?
Because I sure hope so.

MITCH
Oh no. We're gonna go *real slow*.

He DRIVES off.

MITCH (CONT'D)
All right. What happened.

DYLAN
I believe I was promised an aux
cord in this arrangement?

MITCH
After you explain what went down on
Friday.

DYLAN
Carrie invited me to that house and-

MITCH
Stop. I don't care about that. I
don't care what Carrie did or does.

DYLAN
Yeah, that's really apparent.

MITCH
Tell me about the sign.

DYLAN
The sign that said "innocent?"

MITCH
Yeah! I mean, that's gotta be a
ghost. What do you think they want?

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

DYLAN *
Do you believe in ghosts? *

Mitch looks at her: *um...obviously.* *

MITCH *
Open that glove compartment. *

Dylan does and BONES FALL OUT. She SCREAMS. *

MITCH (CONT'D) *
Oh. No. Not that. Look in the back. *
There should be a bag back there. *

Dylan reaches in, pulls out a BAG. She opens it with anticipation only to find a GRANOLA BAR. *

MITCH (CONT'D) *
Aaay! *

DYLAN *
What is this?! I thought you were *
gonna show me proof of ghosts or *
something. *

MITCH *
Nah. I'm just hungry. Hand it over? *

Staring directly at Mitch, Dylan PEALS the granola bar and takes a huge BITE. He looks at her, mouth wide. SILENCE. *

MITCH (CONT'D) *
That was low. *

DYLAN *
Payback. For ruining my poem. And *
being annoying. *

MITCH *
That's fair. You're a great writer. *

DYLAN *
Thanks... *

Awkward. A beat. *

DYLAN (CONT'D) *
Why do you like all this paranormal *
stuff so much anyway? I mean, it *
doesn't creep you out at all? *

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

MITCH

Definitely not. I think it's cool.
You know? The way something gone
can still be here.

DYLAN

Well, I hate it.

MITCH

Why?

DYLAN

If something is buried, it should
stay there. If not, it'll just drag
something else into the hole it
left unfilled. That's been my
experience anyway.

MITCH

Seeds are buried too.

DYLAN

Yeah. Your point is?

MITCH

Well, how do you grow a plant?

DYLAN

Sunlight. Water.

MITCH

Right. But tears are water too.
Sweat is water. Maybe the ghosts
aren't digging themselves out.
Maybe you're the one watering them,
giving them power over you.

Dylan goes quiet.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Are you OK? Not just from Saturday
morning, but Friday night too...
Everything.

DYLAN

I'll be fine as long as I never
have to go into hell house again.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (3)

MITCH

What?! I love it there! You've just gotta go with the right people. Plus, that sign...I know everything there is to know about paranormal investigation, did you know that? If I had the equipment...shit. I'd be in there every night trying to prove the innocence of that ghost.

*

Dylan looks at Mitch, gears turning.

MITCH (CONT'D)

(handing Dylan the aux)
As promised. Damn, I'm dying to know what your music taste is.

DYLAN

(preparing the song)
Well, it's not usually this. Like at all, but... in honor of Carrie being the literal worst...

Dylan plays "She's so Mean" by STUPID BALL PIT CULT. The second it starts, Mitch LAUGHS hysterically.

*

MITCH

SHUT THE FUCK UP. You actually listened to it?!

DYLAN

Against my own will and then out of curiosity.

*

MITCH

Curiosity. You're so goddamn funny, Dillstick.

Mitch starts comedically SINGING the song, putting on a full performance that's impossible for Dylan not to smile at.

MITCH (CONT'D)

COME ON, you got this part!

Somewhat shy, Dylan joins in on SINGING the chorus.

MITCH (CONT'D)

LET'S GOOOO. Louder now! Screaming. Like you really fucking mean it!

*

MITCH (CONT'D)

SHE'S SO MEAN!

DYLAN

SHE'S SO MEAN!

*

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (4)

MITCH (CONT'D)

Oh shit, Folks, I think she's got
it! She's got a voice! She's got
something to say!

Despite herself, Dylan LAUGHS as Mitch looks at her.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - DAY

Jill opens the door.

JILL

I don't like him.

DYLAN

Neither do I.

She looks back to see Mitch's truck driving away.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

But he's very persistent.

Dylan's phone vibrates: "visit day!!" She smiles.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

Gotta go. Lots of homework.

Jill watches Dylan leave, suspicious.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE / ATTIC - DAY

Nathan APPEARS on Dylan's laptop screen. He speaks on mute.

DYLAN

Dad! Hi. Press the unmute button.

NATHAN

Hello? Ah, Jack-O! Well? How was
your first week in Black Willow?

DYLAN

(optimistic)

Uh...

A patient SCREAMS, so haunting that it even draws Nathan.

DYLAN (CONT'D)

Dad?

PATIENT (O.S.)

SOPHIE! SOPHIE IS DEAD!

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

NATHAN

What?!

Nurses SCRAMBLE as patients reach HYSTERICS.

DYLAN

Dad! What happened to her?

NATHAN

I have to go, OK? I love you. Find the card! *Five of diamonds.*

Dylan's screen goes BLACK. The SILENCE rings.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, SECRET HALLWAY - DAY

Dylan RUNS through the secret corridor and into-

INT. DYLAN'S BEDROOM - DUSKHer bedroom. Scours to find the card. Does. She checks the back and discovers writing: "Doc: 11-18-15-11-15-4-9-12."Laptop's on desk. She gets her stale journal, writes: "Doc = Doctor." She researches "deck of card symbolisms." Reads. Writes: "diamond = Autumn, ethics, air" and "five = change."

DYLAN

Change... a change in the medicine.

Dives back in, writes: "11-18-15-11-15-4-9-12." She dials.

RECEIVER

The number you've dialed does not exist. Please-

Frustrated, Dylan looks up. Sees a poster of TAYLOR SWIFT.

DYLAN

OF COURSE!

Dylan gives Taylor a nod of respect, writes: "11=k, 18=r, 15=o, 11=k, 15=o, 4=d, 9=i, 12=l (krokodil)."Dylan looks it up, find an article. New drug. Originated in Chicago. Eats flesh, turning it scaly and green. DEADLY.

It is now DARK outside and in. Dylan looks up, desperate for an answer, and, knee deep in a grave he dug, she sees Mitch.

EXT. GRAVEYARD ENTRANCE - NIGHT

Dosed with confidence, Dylan approaches the graveyard. Mitch watches curiously as she HESITATES at the ENTRANCE, waving.

He teases her: *who? Me? No! You don't wanna come in here? Hm.* He HOPS the FENCE, goes to her.

DYLAN
If I gave you that equipment, could you really prove ghosts exist?

MITCH
Just maybe. Why?

DYLAN
I want you to.

MITCH
Would this be a joint effort?

DYLAN
I thought you wanted to do this.

MITCH
Yeah, but now I only wanna do it if I can do it with you.

DYLAN
Fine. I guess. But the proof has to be objective. We can't prove that ghost is innocent unless we prove it exists, right?

MITCH
I mean...

DYLAN
It *has* to be objective. As in, from that moment forth, ghosts would be taken off the list of fantasy creatures. I need it to be like... ghosts are real. That's it.

MITCH
You're asking if I can change the world for you? Bet.

Mitch is having fun now. He starts to circle her.

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED:

MITCH (CONT'D)

So you'll be my apprentice. I'll
teach you all there is to know
about paranormal investigation,
train you on how to connect with
the spirit realm. Then, together,
we'll clear the name of an innocent
soul, proving that ghosts exist.

DYLAN

Yeah, that they're *real*.

MITCH

That they're real. Yeah. I like it.
It won't be easy, you know. You'll
have to go into hell house again...
And again.

He looks at her expression: a mixture of fear and annoyance.

MITCH (CONT'D)

You'll have to go in at night. When
they say ghostly moans of despair
in that locked bedroom at the end
of the hall can be heard clearest.

Dylan sees hell house behind a thick layer of fog, could
swear that something is seeing her back.

MITCH (CONT'D)

Then the only way to prove a thing
is to stand still, allowing the
dead to materialize as you watch.

Dylan gulps, filled with terror.

MITCH (CONT'D)

But the hardest part of all...
you'll have to resist me.

DYLAN

I think I can manage.

MITCH

You can't even come into my front
yard.

DYLAN

I'll do it.

MITCH

Why?

(CONTINUED)

CONTINUED: (2)

DYLAN *
 Because justice is important to me. *
 Mitch lets this sink in. *
 MITCH *
 Nah. *
 He walks away. *
 DYLAN *
 Mitch! I need this, OK? I can do *
 it. I can. *
 He turns. *
 MITCH *
 Prove it. *
 It occurs to Dylan, for the first time, that this is a boy. *
 DYLAN *
 How? *
 Mitch grins. *
 MITCH *
 Bury a body. *

63

INT. EVIDENCE ROOM - DAY

63

An **OFFICER** unlocks the door to the evidence room of the Black Willow police station, letting Miguel in. *

OFFICER
We had it set out.

MIGUEL
Thank you.

The officer LEAVES and Miguel, wearing GLOVES, approaches a BOX titled "EVIDENCE." Inside, he sees some BLANKETS, a lot of JASPER STONES, SALT PACKETS, and Candice's WALLET. *

Buried below it all, needle shaking towards North, Miguel finds something very familiar to us: *

A BROKEN COMPASS. *

END OF EPISODE *